

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Geometry and Trigonometry	Area and volume	Hard

Question

A manufacturer determined that right cylindrical containers with a height that is 4 inches longer than the radius offer the optimal number of containers to be displayed on a shelf. Which of the following expresses the volume, V , in cubic inches, of such containers, where r is the radius, in inches?

Answer

- A. $V = 4\pi^3$
- B. $V = \pi(2r)^3$
- C. $V = \pi^2 + 4\pi$
- D. $V = \pi^3 + 4\pi^2$

Correct Answer: D

Rationale

Choice D is correct. The volume, V , of a right cylinder is given by the formula $V = \pi r^2 h$, where r represents the radius of the base of the cylinder and h represents the height. Since the height is 4 inches longer than the radius, the expression $r + 4$ represents the height of each cylindrical container. It follows that the volume of each container is represented by the equation $V = \pi r^2 (r + 4)$. Distributing the expression πr^2 into each term in the parentheses yields $V = \pi r^3 + 4\pi r^2$.

Choice A is incorrect and may result from representing the height as $4r$ instead of $r + 4$. Choice B is incorrect and may result from representing the height as $2r$ instead of $r + 4$. Choice C is incorrect and may result from representing the volume of a right cylinder as $V = \pi r h$ instead of $V = \pi r^2 h$.